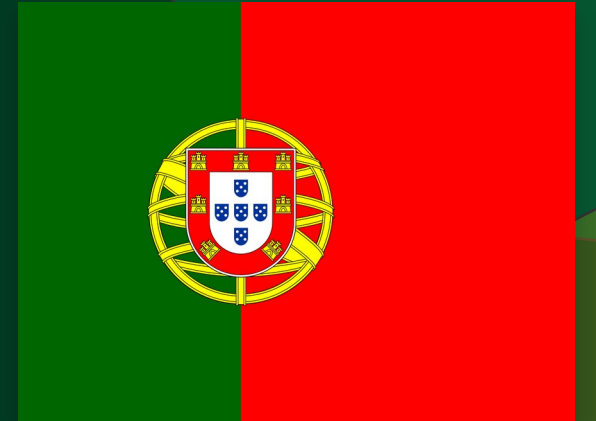


IAFA • INTERCULTURAL ASSOCIATION FOR ALL

Welcome to Portugal and the Portuguese Language

Portuguese Course • Beginner Level

Part 1 The history of Portugal **Part 2** Portuguese in practice



PART 1

The History of Portugal

Where does Portugal come from?

1

Where is Portugal?



- It lies in **south-western Europe**, on the Iberian Peninsula.
- To the west and south: the **Atlantic Ocean**.
- To the north and east: **Spain** — its only neighbour.
- The capital is **Lisbon**.
- The islands of the **Azores and Madeira** are also Portuguese.

The ancient roots



Before Rome

The Lusitanians and other ancient peoples lived here. Viriato was a famous chief.



The Romans (2nd c. BC)

They brought Latin — the origin of Portuguese. They called the region «Lusitania».



Germanic peoples (5th c.)

After Rome, the Suebi and the Visigoths arrived.

711 — The arrival of the Moors



In **711**, the Moors (Muslims from North Africa) conquered almost the whole Iberian Peninsula.

They called it «**Al-Andalus**» and stayed for many centuries, leaving their mark on farming, architecture and the language.

Words we inherited from Arabic

almofada

azeite

açúcar

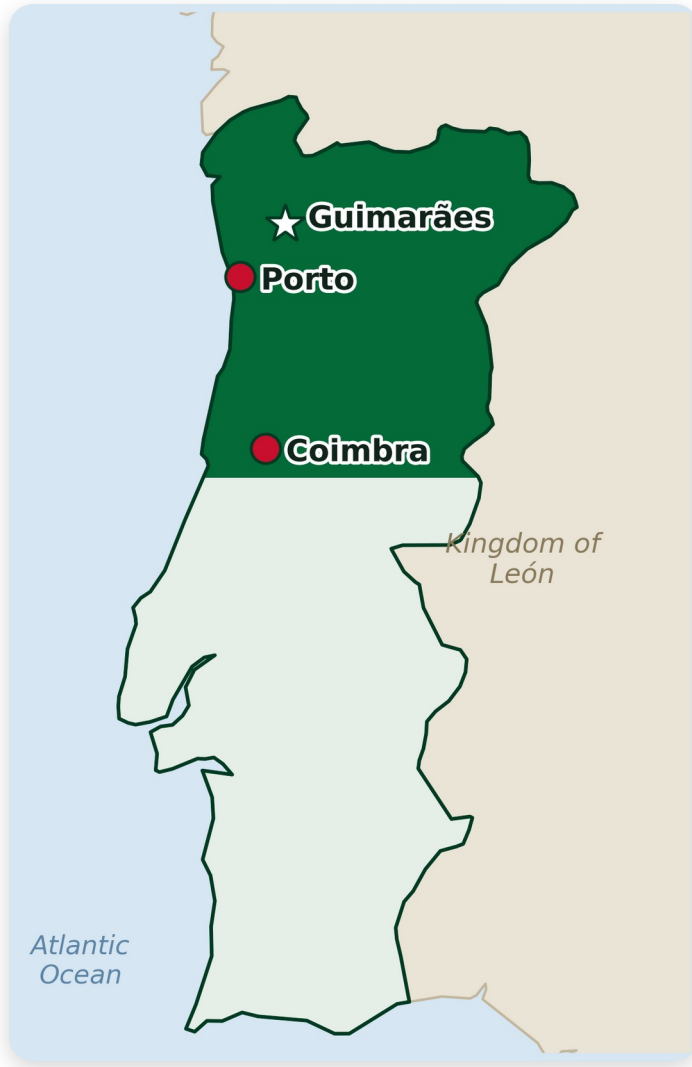
alface

oxalá

alfândega

The County of Portugal

Condado Portucalense · around 1096



- In the 11th century, Christian kings were pushing south against the Moors. New land needed loyal lords to defend and settle it.
- Around 1096, King Afonso VI of León rewarded the knight Henry of Burgundy (Dom Henrique) — married to his daughter Teresa — with the County of Portugal.
- It was a small territory in the north, between the Minho and Douro rivers, later reaching Coimbra.
- Its name came from Portucale, the old port at the mouth of the Douro (today Porto): **Portucale → Portugal**.
- Guimarães, in the heart of the county, is remembered as the cradle (berço) of Portugal.

Dom Afonso Henriques

The first King of Portugal · c. 1109–1185



KEY FACTS

BORN

c. 1109, Guimarães

PARENTS

Count Henry & Teresa

BECAME KING

1139 / 1143

REIGN

about 46 years

REMEMBERED AS

the founder of Portugal

- As a boy, Afonso inherited the County of Portugal from his father, Count Henry of Burgundy.
- His mother Teresa ruled as regent, but grew close to powerful Galician nobles — many feared the county would fall back under León.
- Afonso rebelled. In 1128, at São Mamede (near Guimarães), he defeated his mother's forces and took control himself.
- He first called himself Prince, and after the great victory at Ourique (1139), King of Portugal.
- He reigned about 46 years — one of the longest in Europe — and is remembered as the founder of Portugal.

Two battles that made a king

São Mamede & Ourique



1128

Battle of São Mamede

Near Guimarães, Afonso defeated the army of his mother Teresa and her Galician allies — and became the sole ruler of the county.

1139

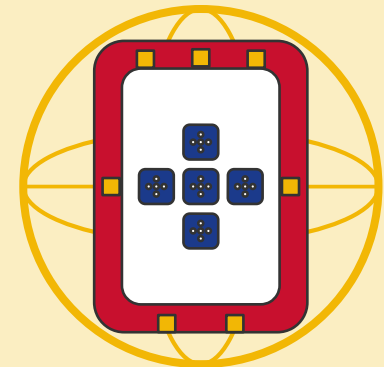
Battle of Ourique

A famous victory over a much larger Moorish army in the south. After it, Afonso was acclaimed King of Portugal.

The legend of Ourique

Legend says that before the battle, Christ appeared to Afonso and promised victory. He is said to have defeated **five Moorish kings** — and that is why the flag carries the **five blue shields (quinas)**, each with five white dots for the wounds of Christ.

A tradition, not proven history — but it explains the flag!



1143 — Portugal becomes independent

1143

the year of the 1st King of Portugal



Treaty of Zamora

The King of León recognises Portugal's independence.



The first King

Afonso Henriques is the 1st King of Portugal.

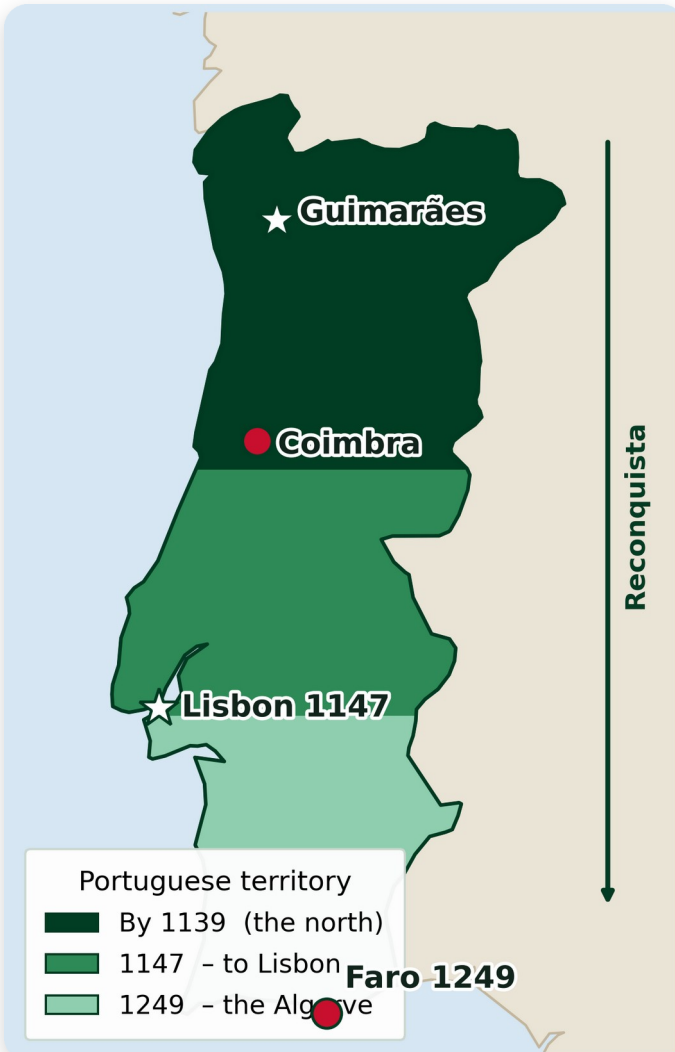


1179 — the Pope

The Church also recognises Portugal as a kingdom.

The Reconquista

Reconquest — growing southwards



The **Reconquista** was the slow, centuries-long reconquest of Iberia from Moorish (Muslim) rule by the Christian kingdoms. For Portugal, it advanced steadily from north to south:

1143

The north

Afonso Henriques rules the northern county and is recognised as the first King.

1147

Lisbon

With passing crusaders, he takes Santarém and Lisbon, on the river Tagus.

1249

The Algarve

King Afonso III takes Faro — the territory reaches the south coast and is complete.

1297 — Borders that have barely changed

One of the oldest borders in the world

+700

years with the same borders



In **1297**, the Treaty of Alcanizes set the border with Castile (Spain).

Since then, Portugal's borders have barely changed. They are among the oldest in all of Europe!

The Age of Discovery

Why Portuguese travelled the world



In the 15th and 16th centuries, Portugal explored the oceans.

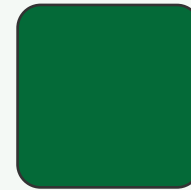
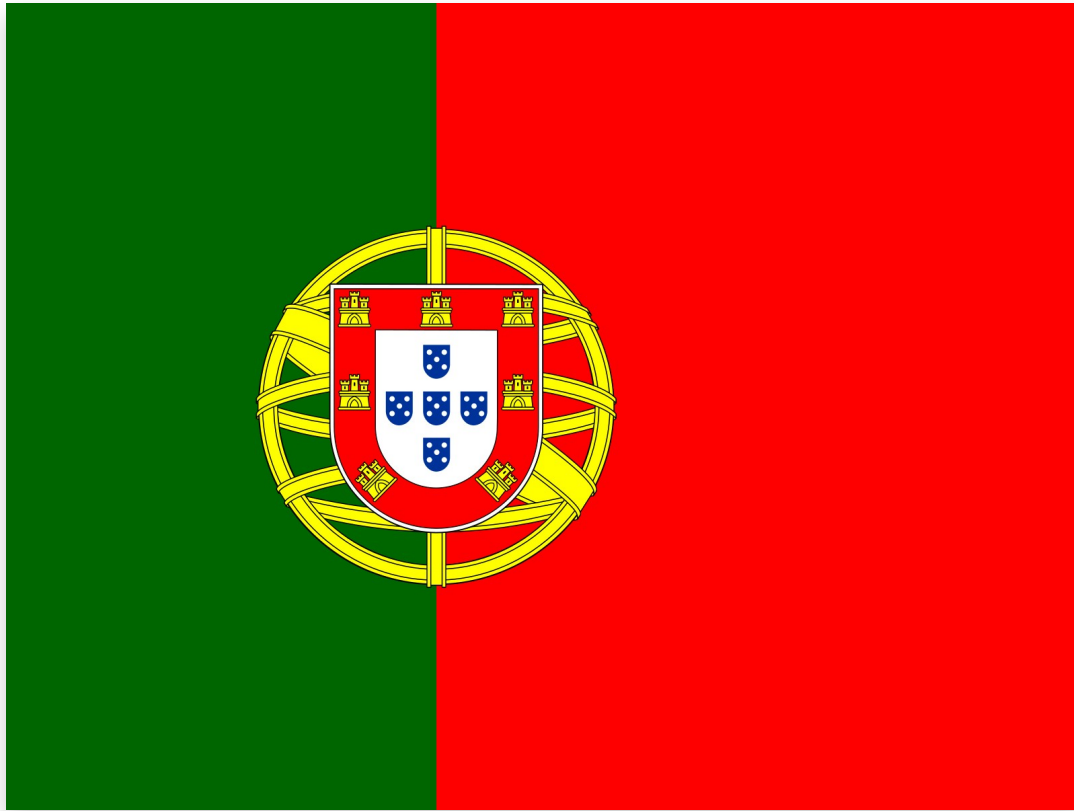
Portuguese navigators reached **Africa, India and Brazil**. This is how the Portuguese language travelled across several continents.



+260

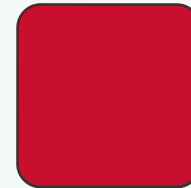
million people speak Portuguese today

The Flag of Portugal



Green (verde)

Traditionally, hope.



Red (vermelho)

The courage and blood of those who fought for the homeland.

The current colours were adopted with the Republic, in 1910–1911.

The symbols on the flag



The armillary sphere

An old navigation instrument. It recalls the Age of Discovery.



The 5 blue shields (quinas)

Legend says they are the 5 Moorish kings defeated at Ourique.



The white dots

Traditionally, the 5 wounds of Christ.



The 7 yellow castles

The fortresses captured from the Moors.

Portugal — a timeline

From the Moors to today

Arrival
of the Moors

711

Independence
of Portugal

1143

Borders
defined

1297

Current
flag

1911

1096

County of
Portugal

1249

Conquest of
the Algarve

15th c.

Age of
Discovery



PART 2

Portuguese in Practice

Let's read and write!

2

The alphabet

26 letters — and how to say each one

A a á	B b bê	C c cê	D d dê	E e é	F f efe	G g gê
H h agá	I i i	J j jota	K k capá	L l ele	M m eme	N n ene
O o ó	P p pê	Q q quê	R r erre	S s esse	T t tê	U u u
V v vê	W w dâblío	X x xis	Y y ípsilon	Z z zê		

 5 vowels

 21 consonants

The name is under each letter — try spelling your own name aloud!

Vowels and consonants

The 5 vowels

a e i o u

The 21 consonants

b c d f g h j k l m n
p q r s t v w x y z



The letters **K**, **W** and **Y** are used mainly in foreign words and symbols: km, kg, W = West, William, Yara.

A few special sounds

Unstressed «E» is weak

barely heard

menino

telefone

cidade

«A» and «O» at the end: closed

a more closed sound

bota

gato

livro

«B» and «V»: similar sound

listen carefully!

Barata

Vaca

Bola

The letter «R» — two sounds

Strong R

at the start of a word, or «rr»

Rato

Rua

Horror

carro

cigarra

terra

Soft R

alone in the middle of a word

árvore

cara

porta

mar

cores

carta

The «S» and «Z» sounds

The «s» sound

S at start • SS • C+e/i • Ç

Sapato

pássaro

Cenoura

Cinema

palhaço

maça

The «z» sound

letter Z • or S between vowels

Zebra

Zero

casa

asa

mesa

rosa

The «J», «G» and «NH» sounds

The «j» sound

J + or G + e / i

Janela

Girafa

Gelo

The «g» sound

G + a / o / u

Galinha

Gato

Gula

«nh» · gue · gui

u is silent in gue / gui

vinho

fogueira

guitarra

The letters «Q» and «X»

The letter «Q»

always with U · «u» is heard only before A

qu**ad**ro

qu**as**e

á**gu**a

queijo

aqui

quem

The letter «X»

has several sounds!

pe**x**e (xe)

tá**x**i (ks)

existe (z)

pró**x**imo (s)

Digraphs — two letters, one sound

CH

/ʃ/

chave

LH

/l/

filha

NH

/ɲ/

vinho

RR

/ʀ/

carro

SS

/s/

passe

Diphthongs — two vowels together

ai

pai

ei

queijo

oi

boi

au

pau

eu

pneu

ou

couve

ão

pão

ãe

mãe

õe

põe

Sound detective

Which sound does the red letter make?



casa

s → s or z?

Sapato

s → s or z?

girafa

g → g or j?

gato

g → g or j?

carro

rr → soft or strong?

maçã

ç → s or ch?



Tip for Turkish speakers: the Portuguese **Ç** sounds like [s] (maçã = 'ma-sã'), not like the Turkish Ç!

Say it like a local

Read the dialogue aloud — a tip for Turkish speakers

Read it aloud

ordering a tea

- A** Bom dia! Como está?
- B** Tudo bem! Um chá, por favor.
- A** Com açúcar?
- B** Não, obrigada!

For Turkish speakers

- J** (janela) = the same as your Turkish **J**!
- CH** and **X** (chá, peixe) = your **Ş**.
- Careful: Ç** (açúcar) = **S**, not the Turkish Ç.
- New sounds:** nasal **ão, ãe, õe** (pão, mãe).



Everyday Portuguese

Português do dia a dia

The words and phrases you'll use every day

Greetings

Saudações



Olá

Hello / Hi

Bom dia

Good morning

Boa tarde

Good afternoon

Boa noite

Good evening / night

Adeus

Goodbye

Até logo

See you later

Being polite

Ser educado



Por favor

Please

Obrigado / Obrigada

Thank you (m. / f.)

De nada

You're welcome

Desculpe

Sorry / Excuse me

Com licença

Excuse me (to pass)

Sim / Não

Yes / No

Introducing yourself

Apresentar-se



Olá! Como se chama?

Hello! What's your name?

Chamo-me Ana. E você?

My name is Ana. And you?

Chamo-me João. Muito prazer!

I'm João. Nice to meet you!

De onde é?

Where are you from?

Sou de Barcelos!

I'm from Barcelos!

Numbers 0–10

Os números



0

zero

1

um

2

dois

3

três

4

quatro

5

cinco

6

seis

7

sete

8

oito

9

nove

10

dez



Careful: 1 and 2 change with gender — **um** / **uma**, **dois** / **duas**. A few more: 20 = **vinte** · 100 = **cem**.

Days of the week

Os dias da semana



segunda

Monday

terça

Tuesday

quarta

Wednesday

quinta

Thursday

sexta

Friday

sábado

Saturday

domingo

Sunday



Tip: Monday to Friday end in **-feira** (segunda-feira, terça-feira...). The weekend is **sábado** and **domingo**.

Useful phrases

Frases úteis



Fala inglês?

Do you speak English?

Não percebo.

I don't understand.

Pode repetir, por favor?

Can you repeat, please?

Quanto custa?

How much is it?

Onde fica...?

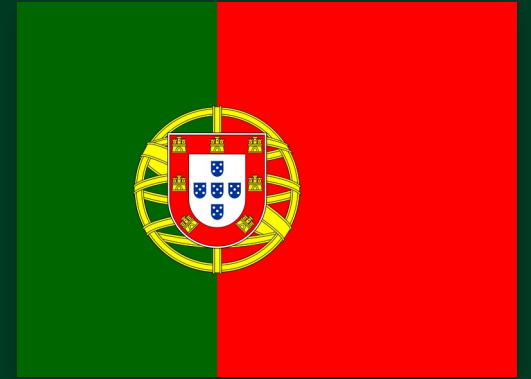
Where is...?

A conta, por favor.

The bill, please.

Obrigado! • Obrigada!

“Thank you!” — see you next class. Welcome to Portuguese, and to Portugal!



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